

LSAT Primer

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I. LSAT Prep Resources

A. Costs of LSAT Prep and Associated Expenses

1. As of September 2026, the LSAC subtotal for one LSAT with LawHub Advantage is \$866: CAS registration \$219, six CAS reports at \$45 each (\$270), one LSAT \$253, and LawHub Advantage \$124. Check current fees at <https://www.lsac.org/lsat/register-lsat/lsat-cas-fees> and <https://www.lsac.org/lawhub>.
2. A sample two-LSAT budget totals \$1,484: \$1,119 in LSAC charges plus an estimated \$365 in application fees for six schools. School fees vary, so this is not an official LSAC total.
3. For a two-LSAT budget that includes tutoring, add \$260 to \$300 in estimated charges to the \$1,484 two-LSAT example for a total of about \$1,744 to \$1,784. Confirm tutoring and class prices before budgeting. Ask good questions and choose tutors who can be productive in one hour to maximize effectiveness.

B. LSAC Fee Waiver Program

1. Apply for an LSAC fee waiver if eligible. As of September 2026, LSAC lists the income limits for each tier below as percentages of the federal poverty guidelines. LSAC also considers maximum asset and cash-balance levels and other factors. To access a

waived LSAT registration, complete two unique full-length LawHub PrepTests in Exam Mode. To access the CAS benefit, complete the required LawHub application course. Check LSAC's current instructions for approval and timing.

- a. For Tier 1, LSAC lists an income limit of up to 235% of the federal poverty guidelines for independent applicants. Dependent applicants have separate limits of up to 150% for their own income and up to 200% for their income combined with their parents' income. The Tier 1 package includes up to two LSAT registrations, a CAS subscription, six CAS reports, and a year of LawHub Advantage, subject to LSAC's current benefit requirements.
- b. For Tier 2, LSAC lists income from 235% to 260% of the federal poverty guidelines for independent applicants. Dependent applicants have separate limits of up to 200% for their own income and from 200% to 300% for their income combined with their parents' income. The Tier 2 package includes one LSAT registration, a CAS subscription, three CAS reports, and a year of LawHub Advantage, subject to LSAC's current benefit requirements.

2. Review the current federal poverty guidelines at <https://aspe.hhs.gov/topics/poverty-economic-mobility/poverty-guidelines>.

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3. Read the current fee-waiver benefits and application instructions at <https://www.lsac.org/lsat/register-lsat/lsat-cas-fees/fee-waiver>.

C. Core LSAC Fees

1. LSAC CAS registration costs \$219. Each CAS report costs \$45.
2. Each LSAT costs \$253. Register for two tests for a total of \$506 to avoid a do-or-die situation and provide breathing room due to randomization. Law schools focus on the highest score.

D. Practice and Training Tools

1. LSAC LawHub Advantage costs \$124 per year. Use it for official test practice and course offerings. Avoid unofficial questions, as they do not represent developed and verified LSAT content.
2. Several services offer question practice, including the following options:
 - a. LSAT Demon offers plans with different features and prices. Confirm current pricing and fee-waiver options at <https://lsatdemon.com/>.
 - b. AdeptLR offers adaptive drilling for Logical Reasoning and Reading Comprehension. Confirm the current plan

price and any LawHub Advantage requirement at <https://www.adeptlr.com/>.

E. Tutoring and Group Instruction

1. Private tutors: Search Facebook Groups such as LSAT Study Group. Rates average \$100 per hour. Two to four hours per week suffices.
2. Group classes: Some are free, such as those with LSAT Demon. Paid options typically cost less than \$50.

F. Free and Supplementary Materials

1. Use the official free LSAT PrepTests available through LSAC LawHub.
2. Search online for LSAT practice tests in PDF format.
3. Find detailed explanations through the PowerScore and Manhattan Prep forums and LSAT Demon videos by Nathan and Ben.
 - a. PowerScore explanations at <https://forum.powerscore.com/>.
 - b. Manhattan Prep explanations at <https://www.manhattanprep.com/lsat/forums/>.

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4. Listen to Thinking LSAT and LSAT Demon Daily at <https://www.thinkinglsat.com/podcasts/thinking-lsat> and <https://www.thinkinglsat.com/podcasts/lsat-demon-daily>.

II. LSAT Study Timeline and Strategy

A. Duration and Registration

1. Plan for at least three months of study.
2. Register for at least two LSATs.

B. Daily and Weekly Routine

1. Study at least one hour per day, five days per week, with two rest days. Ensure one hour without distractions. Treat sessions as an important meeting or date.
2. Study one section at a time. Drill questions and review your answers.

C. Practice Tests and Readiness

1. Introduce practice tests later in preparation.

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2. Use practice test scores matching your target score as a readiness indicator.

D. Mindset and Learning Principles

1. The LSAT is a learnable test, not a knowledge-based test.
2. Treat the LSAT like a gym for the brain.
3. Every mistake offers a chance to learn and apply to future questions.
4. Note efficient solutions and steps to avoid future mistakes.

III. Effective Practice Test Strategies

A. Section Structure

1. The current test has two scored Logical Reasoning sections and one scored Reading Comprehension section. An unscored experimental section, either Logical Reasoning or Reading Comprehension, appears as the fourth. Treat every section as scored.
2. Aim to answer as many questions correctly as possible while managing the time needed for each question.

B. Scoring Targets and Pacing

1. For a target score of 167, consult the raw-to-scaled conversion table for a recent official PrepTest and set a practice target for that form. The number of correct answers needed can vary by test. Perfection is unnecessary.
2. Prioritize mastery over completion. Reserve five minutes to guess unanswered questions. Each has a one-in-five chance of being correct. There is no penalty for wrong answers.

C. Analysis During and After Tests

1. Analyze the passage and question. Avoid fixating on answers. Predict a likely answer before reviewing the choices. Only one answer is correct. The other answers are wrong.
2. Be critical. Question arguments.
3. Pause if the material feels overwhelming. Review what you have read so far.
4. Ensure understanding before advancing. Restate the argument in plain language. Find real-life examples.
5. After each test, review the questions you missed by answering these questions:
 - a. Why did you choose the wrong answer?

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- b. Why did you miss the correct answer?
 - c. What specific action will help you avoid the same mistake?
Write a step you can use, such as reading more slowly or tracking how the argument develops.

IV. Logical Reasoning Section

A. Core Process

1. Understand the passage.
2. Translate the question.
3. Predict the answer.
4. Compare your predicted answer with the choices, then select the answer that best matches the prediction.

B. Note-Taking Advice

1. Avoid taking notes while doing the problems. Notes waste time and increase confusion.

C. Example Application (June 2007 LSAT)

1. Passage: A scientist claims Earth's average annual temperature increased by 0.5 degrees Celsius over the last century. This

warming results primarily from minor gases in the atmosphere that block outward heat flow. Critique: The claim is conclusory. It lacks evidence and assumes causation without alternatives.

2. The question asks which statement, if true, counts as evidence against the scientist's explanation. Predict evidence for an alternative cause or against gas causation.
3. Review each answer choice against the scientist's explanation:
 - a. (A): Only some minor gases allegedly causing the phenomenon were produced by industrial pollution. This is irrelevant. It does not challenge the gases' primary role.
 - b. (B): Most warming occurred before 1940, while most gas buildup occurred after 1940. This separates timelines and weakens the link.
 - c. (C): Over the last century, Earth received slightly more solar radiation in certain years than in others. This suggests an alternative cause. The impact remains unclear.
 - d. (D): Volcanic dust and other particles reflect much of the sun's radiation into space before it reaches Earth's surface. This introduces an unrelated mechanism.
 - e. (E): Minor gas accumulation has been greater over the last century than at any other time in Earth's history. This strengthens the scientist's argument.

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4. If none of the answer choices matches your prediction, compare the choices again. Choice (B) is imperfect, but the gap between the warming and gas-buildup timelines still weakens the scientist's explanation. Among these choices, (B) is the best available answer.

V. Reading Comprehension Section

A. Building Reading Skills

1. Reading is key. Practice with entertaining material for comfort. Challenge yourself with official LSAT Reading Comprehension passages. You do not need Wall Street Journal or SAT exercises.

B. Critical Reading Approach

1. Read critically to identify the passage's overall organization.
2. Identify the main point by asking why the author wrote the passage.
3. Identify each paragraph's topic and explain how it connects to the passage's main point.
4. Determine whether the author supports, opposes, or remains neutral toward the subject.

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5. Avoid notes during reading. They can waste time and cause confusion.

C. Review Protocol

1. Reread the full passage. Retry only the questions you answered incorrectly.

VI. Argumentative Writing Sample

No practice is needed. Focus on clarity.

A. Prompt Structure

1. Read the debatable issue and the three or four supplied perspectives. State a position and use relevant ideas from the perspectives to support it.

B. Response Guidelines

1. State your position, support it with the provided information, and address relevant competing perspectives.
2. A possible three-paragraph structure states your position in the first paragraph, develops your reasons in the second, and

addresses another perspective in the third. Adapt the structure when the prompt calls for more explanation.

3. Use a clear argument summary, explain the supporting reasons, and respond to relevant objections or alternative views.

C. Quality Checks

1. Aim for error-free writing. Avoid typos. Use Oxford commas, proper punctuation, and grammar. Use Grammarly for an additional check.

VII. Additional Resources and Verification

A. Integrated Materials

1. Cross-reference the LSAT Handbook for exhaustive strategies.
2. Use official LSAC PrepTests for practice.